



Individual progress: From left: India's famed quartet, Gurindervir Singh, Amlan Borgohain, Manikanta Hoblidhar and Animesh Kujur, under James Hillier have made strides individually too. Four of the six fastest 100m timings by Indian men belong to them. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

HOW PRECISION IN THE EXCHANGE ZONE CAN POWER INDIA'S SPRINT RELAY SURGE

India's sprint quartet is on a record-breaking run — yet the **real gains** may lie in mastering the baton handover.

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Nothing unnerves a track coach more than a baton exchange in a sprint relay. You could have the fastest runners at your disposal, but even a slightly flawed handover can spell disaster for a relay team.

For Indian sprint coach James Hillier, however, the three 30-metre baton exchange zones on a 100m relay track aren't looming pitfalls. He sees them as fast-moving windows of opportunity — zones that could launch his team into the world's elite.

Under his guidance, the Indian men's 4x100m relay team — comprising Gurindervir Singh, Animesh Kujur, Manikanta Hoblidhar and Amlan Borgohain — broke the national record while representing Reliance at the National Relay Carnival in Chandigarh in April. Their time of 38.69 seconds now places them among Asia's best.